

KEITH DUNSTAN found that the man behind the Melbourne Cup is just a little sensitive about some of the fun and frivolity.

YOU CAN take all our national days. Australia Day is nonsense. Anzac Day is in an advanced state of decay. The Grand Final business is sliding faster than the dollar. Unquestionably the only deeply-felt, passionate, religious holy day is the first Tuesday in November.

The Melbourne Cup is much more than a horse race. It is a national release of internal pressure, a community outburst from the psychiatrist's couch, the true National Day.

The gentleman-figure in charge of all this is Hilton Nicholas. Back in a dim Boltean age he would have been Sir Hilton. Instead, he is just Hilton John Nicholas, OBE.

For his morning suit he prefers matching grey: grey topper, grey tails and grey trousers. Splendid.

One wondered just how many citizens would gather at Flemington this first Tuesday in November?

Hilton Nicholas scratched his head: "I am terrified to think. We have virtually everything happening at once. We will

JOHN WOULDSTRA

HILTON NICHOLAS

The Aspro Kid
has learned to
live with a fancy-
dress party